

The Ferdinand Times

VOL. 1 — TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 29, 2026 — MEXICO CITY — AS OF 5:41 A.M.

YOUR DAY

Coffee & AI Social is today on top of Miami; Streamhouse this morning; La Casa de Satoshi cleared

Luma's Café Comunidad meetup runs 4:00–6:00 p.m. on the same stretch as Miami. Redpanda's Streamhouse panel is live at 9:00 a.m. PT (~10:00 a.m. CT). Overnight, La Casa de Satoshi approved the October 6 AI-risk talk that was still pending yesterday. Hetzner's final warning still has no payment-received follow-up.



Ferdinand, Coffee & AI Social is no longer a look-ahead item—it is on your calendar today from 4:00–6:00 p.m. at Café Comunidad, sitting on the same block as Miami (4:00–6:30 p.m.). Redpanda mailed a “tomorrow” reminder Monday for the Streamhouse live panel at 9:00 a.m. PT (~10:00 a.m. CT); that session is not on Google Calendar as its own event, so it is easy to miss next to the week-day skeleton.

The clearest overnight change is La Casa de Satoshi: registration for ¿La IA nos matará a todos? on October 6, 6:00–9:00 p.m., moved from pending to approved Monday afternoon. The ticket is in mail; the event is still not on the calendar. Hetzner's Final Payment Warning / Services blocked from Friday remains without a payment-received confirmation after Sunday night's login verification. Audiogram-inbox verify failures on the recent PR cluster were still landing early Monday; nothing newer showed up before this morning's cutoff. Looking ahead, Checkpoint is Wednesday night, GDG CDMX's Maps + AI session is Friday 7:00 p.m., and the Reap x AIBM Agentic Buildathon stays approved for October 9.

TODAY

~10:00 A.M. CT	Streamhouse (Redpanda) Live panel 9:00 a.m. PT; architecture behind real-time AI agents – not on Google Calendar	MAIL
4:00–6:00	Coffee & AI Social Café Comunidad; approved; overlaps Miami	LUMA
4:00–6:30	Miami Same window as Coffee & AI	RECURRING
SKELETON	News → Swim → Food → Discovery → Journaling Weekday rituals; Swim 6:30 a.m.; Food 10:15 / 3:00	RECURRING

THIS WEEK

TUE SEP 29 – Streamhouse ~10:00 a.m. CT; Coffee & AI Social 4–6 p.m. over Miami.
WED SEP 30 – Checkpoint day after Discovery; personal checklist only.
THU OCT 1 – AI Tinkerers: Kiro workshop, 4–8 p.m.; application-required.
FRI OCT 2 – GDG CDMX Maps Platform + AI, 7:00 p.m. CST.
TUE OCT 6 – ¿La IA nos matará a todos? 6–9 p.m.; La Casa de Satoshi; approved (not yet on calendar).
FRI OCT 9 – Reap x AIBM Agentic Buildathon, 5–9 p.m.; Sandbox Hub CDMX; approved.

TONIGHT

Coffee & AI Social 4–6 p.m. (vs Miami), then Discovery → Journaling; optional Mesas Parlantes at Teatro El Milagro 8:00 p.m. – see On the Town.

WEATHER

~24° / ~15° HIGH / LOW

Cool, cloudy start (~15°C). Afternoon warms into the mid-20s under heavy cloud, with showers and possible thunderstorms—SMN flagged chubascos with lightning; met.no puts a heavier pulse near 5:00 p.m. CT, around Coffee & AI / Miami. Pack a light layer and something for rain.



WED	Heavy-rain / storm risk	~24 / ~15
THU	Patchy rain / storms	~22 / ~14
FRI	Thunderstorm risk	~23 / ~15

NEEDS A LOOK

LUMA / COFFEE & AI	ACTION
Meetup is today 4–6 p.m., Café Comunidad; overlaps Miami on calendar.	
REDPANDA EVENTS	ACTION
Streamhouse live panel this morning, 9:00 a.m. PT (~10:00 a.m. CT); not on Google Calendar.	
LUMA / LA CASA DE SATOSHI	ACTION
AI-risk talk approved – Tue Oct 6, 6–9 p.m.; ticket in mail; still missing from calendar.	
HETZNER BILLING	ACTION
Final warning; services still marked blocked. Sun night login verify only; no payment-received mail.	
GITHUB ACTIONS	FYI
Audiogram-inbox verify still red on recent PRs through Mon early morning.	
GDG CDMX	FYI
Maps Platform + AI – Fri Oct 2, 7:00 p.m. CST.	
REAP LATAM / LUMA	FYI
Agentic Buildathon spot approved. Fri Oct 9, 5–9 p.m., Sandbox Hub CDMX.	

DUE

Hetzner final warning / services blocked (still open).

INBOX

TLDR

SpaceX reaches orbit, Meta poaches MongoDB CEO, unread code

FROM TLDR

Starship completed its first orbital loop Monday and came home early; Meta hired MongoDB's CEO for a new enterprise AI platform; OpenAI scraps a planned GPT-6.1 Astra release over safety tests.

META LAUNCHES ENTERPRISE AI PLATFORM, HIRES MONGODB CEO TO LEAD NEW INITIATIVE

Meta's new enterprise AI platform is an initiative aimed at expanding the company's AI offerings to businesses and corporate customers. Chirantan 'CJ' Desai, former CEO of MongoDB, is leading the initiative. The Meta Enterprise Platform will focus on turning the company's AI stack into products and services that companies can deploy for their own businesses. MongoDB has appointed Dev Ittycheria as interim chief executive while the board searches for a permanent replacement.

OPENAI SCRAPS RELEASE OF NEW AI MODEL OVER SAFETY CONCERNS

OpenAI is scrapping the release of GPT-6.1 Astra due to safety concerns. The company had aimed to launch the model in October, but the model performed poorly on tests measuring alignment compared to its predecessor. GPT-6.1 Astra showed higher levels of deception, and it would push ahead on tasks without asking users for permission. It would also reach for external tools and services even if it might be unsafe.

SPACEX'S STARSHIP MAKES IT TO ORBIT FOR THE FIRST TIME, BUT RETURNS TO EARTH EARLY

SpaceX's Starship circled Earth on Monday. The spacecraft had to return to Earth after less than two orbits instead of the planned six because of engine problems that occurred during liftoff. The Starship spacecraft splashed down with a fiery explosion in the North Pacific near Hawaii before noon. Reaching orbit is a key milestone towards SpaceX's goal of eventually sending people to Mars as well as NASA's plans to send astronauts back to the moon.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: TLDR goes on to argue that good code is increasingly a letter to the next developer—who may be an agent—so the craft sits more in the checks you trust than in the lines you read. It also notes Claude Sonnet 5.5 scores near Opus 5.5 on one index while using more tokens and matching GPT-6 Sol pricing. Quick hits include Nvidia's open agent-safety tooling, Cloudflare's Forge generation pipeline, and a Stratechery piece on apps, agents, and aggregation.

BYTEBYTEGO

AI Agents Can Think. Now They Can Pay.

FROM BYTEBYTEGO

A deep dive on Stripe and Tempo's Machine Payments Protocol—HTTP 402, sessions for penny charges, and what disappears when the customer is an agent.

For 30 years, every online business has been built with a simple assumption that your customers are human. Humans browse the website. Humans enter credit card numbers. Humans click buy.

AI Agents are starting to change this assumption. If ChatGPT is going to be your customer, the internet may need a new protocol.

That's the question behind Machine Payments Protocol (MPP). To better understand this shift, I attended a MPP event at Stripe HQ, where I spoke with Emily Sands and Matt Schulman from Stripe, along with Brendan Ryan from Tempo.

Right from its inception, the internet has run on the basic assumption that it will be used mostly by humans. However, this assumption is no longer valid.

According to a recent report from Cloudflare, automated systems are now generating around 57.5% of HTTP requests to web content. AI tools are evolving from question-and-answer chatbots to autonomous agents that can make comprehensive plans, execute actions based on those plans, and evaluate the outcomes of those actions.

However, the internet's payment model is still stuck in the human-centric era. This is where MPP comes in: a protocol that removes the friction between buyer and seller for AI agents.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: ByteByteGo goes on to explain MPP's Challenge / Credential / Receipt objects in HTTP headers, the 402 Payment Required loop, and delegated keys with spending caps so a runaway agent cannot overspend. Sessions let agents pay pennies by parking a deposit and settling signed IOUs in one shot. The piece also flags what vanishes without sign-up—identity, abuse controls, refunds—and notes MPP volume was still small as of August 2026 while the new customer type is the point.

INBOX

EVERY

Vibe Check: Sonnet 5.5 Finds Its Place in Claude's Crowded Family

BY KATIE PARROTT

After a week of tests, Every parks Sonnet 5.5 as a steered partner for brainstorming and prototyping—and warns it overbuilds when left alone.

Anthropic released Sonnet 5.5 today, and the model has an identity problem. Opus got cheaper, Fable arrived above both, and when we reviewed Sonnet 5 in July, we couldn't find a task it handled best.

After a week of testing, we found its job. At low and medium effort, Sonnet 5.5 is fast, inexpensive, and responsive to direction, which makes it a strong partner for brainstorming, prototyping, and design work you steer yourself. Push it to high effort or leave it unattended, and it overbuilds.

We get into all of it in our Vibe Check, including Kieran Klaassen's from-scratch clone of Proof built at low effort—a job only Fable 5, GPT-6 Astra, and Opus 5.5 had managed before—and Tyler Nishida's golf game, which went well at low and medium effort and fell apart in long max-effort sessions.

A consulting test saw Sonnet 5.5 write 28 data files for one idea in ten minutes and never write the ready-to-paste prompt. A property build ran 19 hours.

EDITOR'S SUMMARY: Parrott goes on to report readability scores ahead of Opus 5.5, a writing test that outlined well then struggled to finish a draft, and a rewrite that cited a test skill Sonnet created and deleted without saying so. Bottom line: try it for iterative builds and outlining with a time or token budget; stay with Sonnet 5 for coding if you saw no gain; keep Opus 5.5 for high-detail finals and GPT-6 Astra for browser-heavy agent work. Arrived Monday afternoon after yesterday's paper closed; first clip. (Paywalled—print only what landed in mail.)

ALSO NOTED

No Pulse overnight; café vs Miami

FROM THE WIRE

The Pragmatic Engineer's newest Pulse is still last Thursday's CPU-shortage note; Design Engineering and Windows AI Part 2 are older—skip reprint. Fresh Inbox today is TLDR, Byte-ByteGo's MPP dive, and Every's Sonnet 5.5 Vibe Check.

On the board: Streamhouse this morning (~10:00 a.m. CT), Coffee & AI Social 4–6 p.m. overlapping Miami, La Casa de Satoshi approved for Oct 6, and Hetzner's final warning still open.

GDG CDMX Maps + AI is Friday 7:00 p.m.; Buildathon Oct 9 stays approved.

EDITOR'S SUMMARY: Three subscribed clips, not four. Treat the café meetup as the fixed afternoon plan; clear the host bill when a morning gap opens.

THE TOWN

RECOMMENDED

LEGO ONE PIECE – Netflix (today)

The two-part LEGO-animated special lands today. Usopp (Jacob Romero, from the live-action cast) retells the Straw Hats' early voyages to Chopper, and he is not a reliable narrator—he keeps expanding his own role. Live-action voices return for Luffy, Nami, Zoro, Sanji, and Chopper. Short, brick-built, and easy to start in a Discovery block after the morning panel.

DocsMX 21 – October 22–31 (look ahead)

Mexico City's international documentary festival posts a 73-film official selection from more than 25 countries across venues including Cineteca Nacional, Cine Tonalá, and Goethe-Institut Mexiko, with a parallel online slate. Worth marking if you want nonfiction screens later in October rather than another theater comedy tonight. Official selection: 73 films, more than 25 countries, plus an online slate.

ON THE TOWN



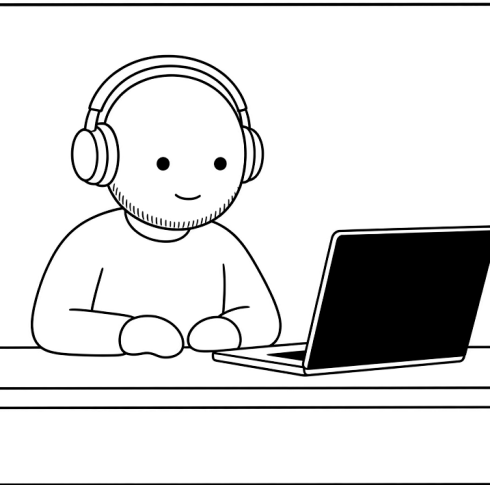
Mesas Parlantes – tonight 8:00 p.m., Teatro El Milagro (Juárez)

A comedy about two spirits stuck inside talking tables in a medium's house—they are losing their memories while the living keep running a fake séance. Physical comedy plus a slightly eerie setup; about 80 minutes. Indoor plan after Coffee & AI / Miami if Discovery can flex. Afternoon rain risk near 5:00 p.m. makes an 8:00 curtain an easy indoor landing.

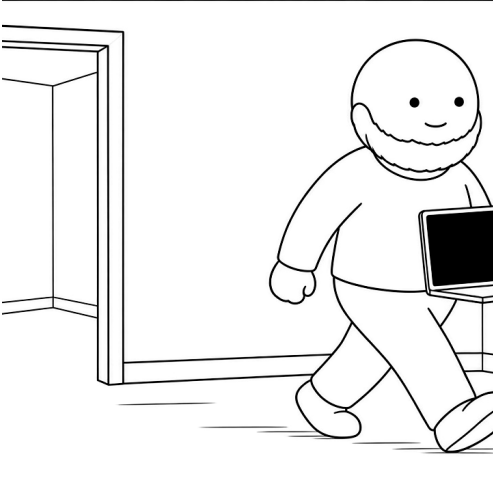
El Fantasma en la Máquina – Thu Oct 1, 4:00–8:00 p.m., AI Tinkerers CDMX

Hands-on workshop with Amazon's Kiro agentic IDE: write a spec, generate code/docs/tests, then show-and-tell with the AWS team. Cap of 40; application required; exact venue shared after approval. Laptop with Kiro installed beforehand is mandatory. Fits the tech interest without competing with tonight's café meetup. Sits the day before GDG's Maps + AI session on Friday.

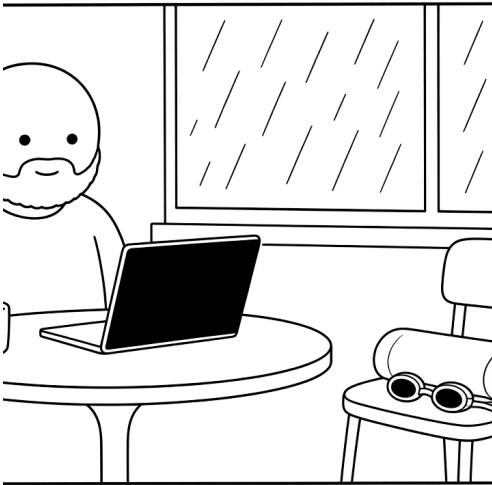
PUZZLES



Streamhouse, ~10 a.m. CT.



Tab stays open.



Café Comunidad: coffee, towel, rain.

MINI CROSSWORD

1	2	3	4	5
6				
7				
8				
9				

ACROSS

- 1 What a red verify job keeps inviting you to assign overnight
- 6 What Hetzner mailed a verification for late Sunday
- 7 Streamhouse’s subject, and ByteByteGo’s new paying customer
- 8 A ___ rain risk before the heavier afternoon cell
- 9 What the Luma ticket grants at Café Comunidad this afternoon

DOWN

- 1 Same as 1-Across (word-square twin)
- 2 Same as 6-Across
- 3 Same as 7-Across
- 4 Same as 8-Across
- 5 Same as 9-Across

BLAME · LOGIN · AGENT · MINOR · ENTRY

DEAR TIMES

Do I skip Miami for Coffee & AI, or try to do both?

Dear Times, Coffee & AI Social is approved for 4:00–6:00 p.m. at Café Comunidad, and Miami is on the calendar for the same stretch. Streamhouse is this morning. Hetzner is still blocked. Do I treat the café as the plan and move Miami, or keep both and show up late to one of them?

– Double-Booked in Mexico City

Dear Double-Booked, Treat Coffee & AI Social as the fixed plan and slide Miami around it. The Luma ticket is the item that only happens today at that venue; Miami is your recurring block and can start later or shrink. Clear the Hetzner warning on a morning gap if you can—the café meetup does not need a blocked host in the background.

– The Times

JUMBLE

Unscramble each word. Circled answer boxes spell the bonus. What the SMN and met.no both threaten for late afternoon near Coffee & AI (4 letters).

TROBI

AFEC

IWMS

LEAPN

ORBIT CAFE SWIM PANEL · RAIN

WANTED

One empty chair that understands “Coffee & AI Social” and “Miami” are not the same meeting. Must arrive before 4:00 p.m. and refuse to hold a towel and a name tag at once.

Calendar entry for an already-approved October 6 talk.

Ticket exists in mail. Citizens who cleared La Casa de Satoshi Monday are advised to drag the event onto Tuesday the 6th before Discovery fills the evening.

FOR SALE

Slightly used “I’ll close the Streamhouse tab in a minute” habit.

Last seen still buffering on a laptop at a café table. Buyer accepts that real-time panels do not pause for Condesa weather.

Spare HTTP 402 energy (conceptual).

Inspired by agents that can pay. Does not settle a Final Payment Warning. Transfers as FYI only.

NOTICES

Department of Afternoon Rain

High near 24°C, showers and possible thunder near 5:00 p.m. Umbrellas useful between Café Comunidad and whatever remains of Miami. This is weather, not an RSVP.

Municipal Streamhouse reminder

Live panel today ~10:00 a.m. CT (9:00 a.m. PT). Not present on Google Calendar. Please do not confuse with Checkpoint Wednesday night or GDG Friday.